

How to Create Time

Same 24 Hours. Different Output.

Time creation for the rest of us.

An eight-week system distilled from corporate strategic-vision coaching.

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The idea came out of corporate strategic-vision coaching and other work on efficiency and happiness. The executive version was built for CEOs and owners. Two weeks, if you already have a mission. This book is for anyone who needs to get more done — employee, boss, owner, or the person who does not have a title and still ran out of week. Eight weeks, if you do the weeks. I will save you the tens of thousands of dollars people pay for that executive version. This costs hundreds of times less than a single hour of the training it came from. The short version, if you already have the vision: Step one: write down your strategic vision, broken into priorities. Maximum of five. Step two: delete everything on your calendar that is not related to those five. Step three: put what remains into fifteen-minute blocks and fill the next fourteen days. The end. Add phrases like “Strategic Vision Alignment” or “Corporate Mission Reconcentration.” First, company revenue goes up. Second, you can charge a decent amount for the hour. That advice works when the person already has a mission. The leader of a company, hopefully, has a purpose, a strategy, and a vision. They only need to line the hours up. Two weeks to see that time and priorities were never friends. Outside that room, the advice fails. Most people do not have the clarity, the focus, or even a general picture of where they are heading. You probably do not have a mission statement for your life. Most entrepreneurs, small businesses, and even midsize leaders do not have one either. Most people have wants, desires, complaints. Some have hopes, dreams, goals. A

clear vision is rare. For the most part people are just trying to get by. Flying blind. This book exists to get you from Point A — where you are now — to the place where those three steps actually work. That is why it takes eight weeks instead of two. Time is a lot like energy. Physics aside, it cannot be created or destroyed. It can be used to make something. It can be wasted. Every person on earth has the same amount. Who you were yesterday. Who you are today. Who you will be tomorrow. Everyone you look up to. Everyone you look down on. Everyone you envy. Everyone you hate. Same hours in the day. You can get more money. You can get a new spouse, a new job, a new hobby. You cannot get more time. You can only create time by lining the hours up and dropping what is not the vision. Time creation sits on two numbers: two weeks and fifteen minutes. You pick or create a vision. You give it time equal to how much it matters. You put that time on the calendar in fifteen-minute blocks, always fourteen days out. You cannot create time if you are not working toward something with the time. You cannot fly from Point A to Point B if you do not have a Point B. It does not matter how good the plane is. A Tesla will happily drive you into a tree. A RAV4 will happily take you where you tell it to go. Neither will get you anywhere if you have no destination. So the first step in creating time is a destination. A Point B. That is not motivation. That is not passion. If you know someone passionate about staying afraid of snakes, they are a rarity. The story that you need a deep desire before you can move is nonsense. You are in a burning building on an island. The room still has a chair. The beach still has shade. Across the water you can see the other shore. The week is familiar. Familiar is comfort. Comfort stays. Will is first. You want to go there. Clarity is seeing it, and seeing yourself already there. Focus is not chasing a second island mid-swim. Determination is keeping on when the water hits rock. Commitment is leaving the safe beach, including the times the raft sinks. Ninety-nine percent stay. They are comfortable. They are afraid. Or they wait for a feeling they were told they had to have first. The number-one human instinct is comfort. Do what is familiar and die. The number-two instinct is survival. Leave. There is a third move that is neither. Wait for the government, God, family, or the lottery to pull you out of the building. That is not faith. That is sitting in the smoke and calling it a plan. People say survival is first. That does not hold. If it were first, overdoses would not happen, wrecks would not happen, and we would still be in the cave. Instead of flying a plane in circles: pick Point B. No speech about passion. No permission from the room. If your actual house does not have a fire escape plan, get one. Then use the same picture on the week. The rest of this book is eight weeks of how to leave. Week 0 is Point B — what you want, and the pile in the way. Week 1 is ink. Do not

skip the paper.

Week 0 — What do you want?

If you already have a goal, still do this. If you do not, this is how you get one.

Work: the Have / Want quadrant

Get a piece of paper. Analog is better. Phone is fine. Draw a line down the middle. Draw a line across the middle. Four boxes. Top left — Have and want. Keep these. Top right — Have and do not want. A lot of these shrink when you move toward the box below. Bottom left — Do not have and want. This is Point B. Bottom right — Do not have and do not want. Leave them there. Fill every box. Do not polish. Lists, not essays. If bottom left is empty, you have two honest moves. Figure out how to give and serve other people. Or want to need a jet. Do not want a private jet. They are a waste of money. Want so much going on, in so many places, that you need the jet to get the most out of the hours. You do not need a SMART goal. You need something in Don't Have and Want, or you help people, or you want to need the jet. It does not matter to me what the destination is. There are new people at the destination. The people at the origin can be picked up later. What does matter: you are not sending explosives to anyone. Stay inside what is legal where you live, what would survive a jury of your peers, and what matches your own ethics. If that sentence feels abstract: there was a mathematician, youngest assistant professor at Berkeley at twenty-five, who later spent seventeen years mailing bombs and killed three people. In the document that made him famous he wrote that people need a goal that takes effort, and they need to hit some of those goals or they rot. That last part is true for almost everyone. The bombs were still murder. That is why, if bottom left is empty, this book does not say "sit there until a passion arrives." It says give. Serve. Charity. Help someone else get off their island. A hard goal aimed at other people fills that hole. It does not get anyone killed. Empty Don't Have and Want is a problem. Filling it with a felony is not a Point B. Nowhere in this box is there a requirement for interest, passion, or finding yourself.

Backup: I don't know what I'm good at / what I want

If bottom left is still blank, do Ikigai. Say it icky-guy-ah. Four circles. Where they overlap is the next guess at Point B. What you love What you are good at What the world needs What you can be paid for Lists. The middle is not a personality test. If the middle is still empty, you are not broken. Go to the stop point.

Stop point

“I don’t want anything.” “I don’t want to be better at anything.” “Success is greed.” Generosity goes up with success. Empty-handed charity is a feeling. Funded charity is a schedule. If you still do not know: want to need a jet. Write that in bottom left. Sitting here is comfort. Comfort stays in the building.

Crossing the gap

Everyone starts at Point A. Start. The specific thing you want is Point B. Finish. The gap is what sits between them.

The building

The building is on fire. You are in a room you know. Chair. Screen. A door you could open. Smoke is in the hallway. Heat is at the frame. Two things can happen in the same minute. Catalytic anxiety uses the smoke. You stand up. You find the door. Stairs, not the elevator. You jump if the stairs are gone. You grab who you can grab. You leave. Paralytic anxiety uses the same smoke and sits down harder. The chair is still a chair. The show is still on. The hallway looks worse than the room. So you stay, and you call that waiting for a better exit. Comfort is why paralysis wins. Comfort is the number-one human instinct, not survival. If survival were first, people would not stay in wrecks they could walk away from, and we would not have left the cave only to build nicer chairs. You, reading this, are probably not in a real fire. That is the problem. Nobody filled the apartment with smoke. Nobody took the food off the island. The instinct that should move you has nothing to push against. The bills get paid enough. The week is familiar. Familiar is comfort. Comfort stays. The metaphor is not “your life is literally burning.” The metaphor is: without smoke, comfort keeps you in the building. This book will not set your house on fire. It will also not pretend you will leave just because someone described a door. You do not need to be in love with leaving. You need a reason heavier than the chair. That reason is the line you circled in Don’t Have and Want.

The island

You are stranded on a desert island. That is Point A. Across the channel you can see a tropical island with a resort. That is Point B. Will is first. You want to go there. You can see it. You can imagine yourself there. That is Clarity. Nothing pulls you onto a second island while you cross. That is Focus. Nothing in the water becomes the reason you turn around. That is Determination. You leave this beach and eat the failures — the raft that sinks, the first swim that does not make it. That is Commitment. And the current version of you still will not get in the water. Sharks.

Drowning. Fear of failure and fear of failing. If I miss, I look like Icarus. If I sink, I am a failure. So you sit on sand that is not killing you today and tell the story instead of crossing. You are not starving. You are not in smoke. You are comfortable. Same chair as the building. The fire and the island are the same picture. One room that still has a remote. One beach that still has shade. The gap is the part you do after you want the other shore more than the chair.

Keep it simple

Clarity: there is a fire, get out. Focus: how many exits, who you can take. Determination: a way across. Commitment: you leave, and you help who can still walk. You do not need to love the goal. You are not in love with escaping a fire. You still leave.

Clear the old list

Before you log a week, deal with the pile you already have. Those tasks are not all the one goal. Desk, inbox, head. If you start Cycle 1 on top of that pile, the log will only prove you were buried. Avalanche. Largest first, then down. Snowball. Smallest first, then up. Pick one. Do not switch because a squirrel showed up. If you avalanche and then leave for a new goal, none of that weight drops. If the pile is a product and you keep polishing, someone else ships. If you snowball and then start a new pebble on another hill, you abandoned speed you already paid for. This is not the Don't Have and Want line. This is the mess in the way. Clear enough that a week of ink is possible.

Work

Dump the pile. Open loops. Not new goals. Mark each: avalanche (big) or snowball (small). Circle one method. Do the first item in that order today. When the pile no longer blocks a measured week, go to Week 1. The log does not invent time if you spend the week sorting a stack you refused to pick a method for.

Week 1

Cycle 1

Time on task. ToT. Sixteen waking hours. The mind will hold about seven things before it starts dropping them. So you do not get seven extra destinations. You get a few parts of a life, and one crossing. Self. Family. Friends. Career. Those four are not hobbies. Each one needs a goal of its own: maintain it and let it flourish. That is sustaining livelihood. Faith if that is a real line for you. If it is not, do not invent a box. Optional means optional. That is four boxes, or five. Then the one item you circled in Don't Have and Want. That is five or six. Already near the limit. No safari. If it can be observed, it can be measured. If it can be measured, it can be improved. Most people have never written their hours down. They argue with a feeling. This week you argue with a log.

What you track

The page is P and W. The code is a note on the line. P — productive. The block did what you marked it for. W — wasted. It did not. Code — S, Fam, Fr, C, Fa, G, SO, D, O, X, Ot G is the line from Don't Have and Want. You do not need milestones yet. You need to see whether G got any boxes. Fifteen-minute blocks. Sixteen hours a day. One week. Typical week. Not vacation. One grid. Do not start a second notebook.

Work

For seven days: Fill the Time on Task page. +00:00 and up. Code on the line. P or W. Tally at the bottom: P minutes, W minutes, G blocks, D/SO/O/X count. Date. Day. Cycle 1. When you left G, write the sentence in the margin. That sentence is data. You will name it later. Do not fix the week. Do not start 45/15. Log it. That is Cycle 1. Measurement. Week 2 is one rabbit — the goal written down, milestones, tasks. You keep the same page. You still do not cut the week until Week 3. First you have to see the hours.

Week 2

Clarity

You already want to go. That was Will. Clarity is knowing where. The destination is not a mood. It is one item from Don't Have and Want. That list is the safari. Clarity is picking one line and seeing it done. If you never fail on the way, the destination was too close. The goal was too small. Clarity is knowing what you want, being able to visualize it, and being able to visualize having already achieved it. Most people never wanted to give a TED talk. They wanted to have given a TED talk.

One goal

Do not move the whole Don't Have and Want list at once. You will not. Pick one line. One goal. Big enough that you cannot finish it tonight. If you can knock it out before dinner, it was a chore. Put it back. Pick a larger line. A clear picture: what you want, why, how you plan to get there. Simplicity. Definiteness. Direction. Without that picture you will work hard and wander. Nice view of the other island. Still this beach.

Goal, milestone, task

The goal is Point B. A milestone tells you where you are. You can point at it and say you have moved. A task is the vehicle. No tasks, no crossing. Goal → milestones → tasks. How do you eat an elephant? One bite at a time. A task is a bite. Tonight or this week. A thing that can get an X. Not "work on the business." Three to five milestones. Under milestone one, this week's tasks. Everything else waits. If it is easy, you picked a chore.

The rabbit

He who catches a rabbit eats. He who chases two rabbits catches none. He who chases this rabbit, then that rabbit, loses sight of his destination and his origin. He who seeks admiration or attention loses sight of the rabbit. Be clear which rabbit. Be clear that it is only one. The elephant is how big the WANT has to be. The rabbit is that one line, named.

Work

Open Have / Want. Circle one item in Don't Have and Want. One sentence. See it done. See yourself having done it. Write why it is difficult and still possible. Write three to five milestones. Under milestone one, write this week's tasks.

Cycle 2

You have a week of ink and a sentence. Put them on the same page. Cycle 1 measured whatever you called G. Cycle 2 asks whether G was actually that sentence. Tally last week before you change anything. How many G blocks? How many S / Fam / Fr / C / Fa? How many Ot? If G was empty, last week you had a want and no crossing. If G was full and the sentence you just wrote is a different animal, you were hunting the wrong rabbit and calling it the goal. This week the code G only counts if the block is a task under milestone one. Not “stuff about the business.” Not a new Don’t Have and Want. The bites on the goal page. Keep logging the same way. P or W. Code on the line. Do not start 45/15. Do not kill a distraction yet. You are still learning what the hours were.

Work

Same daily page. Cycle # 2. Write last week’s totals: G / livelihood / Other. Write the goal sentence at the top of this week’s first log page. For seven days, G only if the block is a written task from milestone one. Anything else that felt like the goal is Ot or SO. Cross an X on the goal page when a task is done. Do not cut the week. Do not flip to 45/15. Week 3 is Focus. That is when you take this cleaner G and cut the leak to fifteen minutes in the hour.

Week 3

Focus

Clarity comes first. If you do not know which rabbit you are chasing, you cannot focus on it. You already picked one line. Focus is what you do when a second rabbit shows up. Focus is distractions. Put attention on one goal, on the task in front of you, and leave the rest of the field alone. Same hours. Better use. You can have anything you want. You cannot have everything you want. You can accomplish anything if you put your mind to it. You accomplish nothing if you don't. The second goal, the new logo, the thing that popped up mid-task — that is not extra ambition. That is weight. Treat it as the work and you hit a wall that has nothing to do with Point B. One objective. The milestones you wrote. The task for tonight or this week. That is the laser. The sun puts out a lot of power and lights the whole sky. A sliver of that same power, aimed, starts a fire. You are not short on energy. You are spread. Email. Phone. A new rabbit. Admiration. A chore that feels like progress. That is the sun. The task on the page is the laser. If it is easy, you are still in the hallway.

Work

Same goal page. Do not start a second list. Add any missing bite under milestone one. Start a distraction log on the back of that page. Every time something pulls you off the task: what, when, stayed or chased. Do not turn it into a new goal. Log it. Back on the bite. You cannot drop what you will not name.

Cycle 3

Now cut. Fifteen minutes an hour on things that are not the goal and not sustaining livelihood. Forty-five on task. Fifteen off. Hold that for eight hours. That is 45/15. A normal week is upside down. Most of the hour leaks. You are flipping it. Forty-five is the work. Fifteen is the leak. Look at last week. How much on G (the written tasks)?

How much on Self, Family, Friends, Career, Faith if you kept it?

How much on Other? Where you paid with time and attention is what was important. If Other won, Other was the religion. Change the payments or admit the sermon was fake. Most people spend about eighty percent on things that do not move the goal and do not keep livelihood alive. Twenty percent on the crossing. No goal, and you burn a hundred. Attention is the toll. It does not refill at midnight. Planning and learning count as the forty-five only if they are a written milestone or

they sit before or after the block. In the middle they are a leak with a nicer name.

The test

Does this task get me closer to the goal? No. Then it is a distraction. New Point B on Tuesday. Logo. Font. Slogan. A worry. Write it in the journal. Do not chase it in the forty-five.

How you cut

One distraction per day. The loudest line from the new journal. Kill that one. Tomorrow, the next. A rule, a person, a closed tab. Make the distraction more expensive than the task. Timer on the forty-five. When you look up, the timer is still running. You left. The minutes did not. Build this week from last week's log, not from a fantasy Monday. Copy hours that held. Delete hours that lied. If Monday only gave you two clean hours, start with two. Do not highlight eight you have never kept. Track until you can hold 45/15 for eight hours. Then you have a day you can repeat.

Work

Same daily page. Cycle # 3. Tally last week: G, livelihood, Other. Circle the largest Other. Is that what you want most important? Yes or no. Pick one line from the distraction log. That is today's only kill. Run 45/15 for as many hours as last week proved you can start with. G in the forty-five only if it is a written task. Tomorrow, the next distraction. Do not restart the goal list. Week 4 is Determination — the block that is actually in the way — and the repeats you should stop or hand off.

Week 4

Determination

Understand this. An obstacle is not a problem. A problem is how you stay on the beach and keep the story. An obstacle is what you use. Determination is the unwavering pursuit of one goal when something is in the way. Stay on the line after the first raft sinks. Water does not argue with rock. It does not book a meeting with the canyon. It stays the course. The Colorado River spent an uncivil amount of time in the same channel and cut the Grand Canyon out of stone. That is determination you can walk around in. Be like that water. Do not give a damn that the rock was there first. You will do to the goal what the water does to the rock. Small increments. One goal. Again. Again. Until you can point at the progress. Then you can go get the next line in Don't Have and Want. Not before. Focus named the noise. Determination names what is blocking the goal. Noise you log and leave. The block you use.

Work

Same goal page. Do not start a second list. Under the goal you already wrote, name one obstacle. Next to it, write why that obstacle is an opportunity. Write the next task that uses it. Tonight or this week. Do not add a second goal because this one got hard.

Cycle 4

Hammer the repeats. You have 45/15. Look at what still eats the forty-five and is not the goal and is not sustaining livelihood — Self, Family, Friends, Career, Faith if you kept it. Same motion, every day or every week. Does not move the milestone. Does not keep livelihood standing. Habit wearing a work costume. Total them. Name. Times last week. Minutes. If laundry and dishes show up, that is Week 7. Tools. If getting the boss coffee shows up, Week 7. If driving to work shows up, Week 7. This cycle is the junk loop. The meeting that produces nothing. The report nobody reads. The extra check you do because you have always done it. Biggest minutes first. Three options only: Stop. It does not need to exist. Hand it off. Someone else, a tool, a rule. Keep it — then it is the goal or it is livelihood. Put it in the right box. You will not get this to a hundred the first pass. Next cut. Count again. Next cut.

Work

Same daily page. Cycle # 4. List the repeats that are not the one goal and not sustaining livelihood. Mark laundry, dishes, coffee, commute for Week 7. Total times and minutes. Largest at the top. Stop, hand off, or keep. If keep, write which box. If stop or hand off, write the next action that makes that true this week. Tomorrow, the next line. Week 5 is Failure, Commitment, and the squirrels that are not even repeats — the new shiny thing mid-block.

Week 5

Failure

Two fears. They look the same from the couch. They are not.

Ceiling of failure

Fear of failure stops you from going above a ceiling you already assigned yourself. You can see the next floor. You will not take the stairs. If you miss, someone will watch. If you hit it, the next ceiling appears and you will have to risk again. So you stay under a line you picked when you were tired, broke, or thirteen. This one is easy to explain. Icarus. The warning everyone remembers is “don’t fly too close to the sun.” The part they skip is that he was also told not to fly too close to the water. Most people only use the sun. They treat any height as arrogance. That is how a ceiling gets installed. Believe and achieve is the opposite sentence. Not magic. If you will not believe the next floor is allowed, you will not take the step that would prove it.

Floor of failure

Fear of being a failure keeps you from going below a floor. Sea level. Some people are so afraid of looking like a failure that they never do anything that could drop them. They stay employed at the safe job, in the safe town, with the safe story, because under that line is “failure” as an identity, not as a miss. They will not start the business. They will not ship the ugly first version. They will not ask. A miss would put them under the floor in public. So they hover just above sea level and call it responsible. The ceiling says “don’t you dare go higher.”

The floor says “don’t you dare fall.”

Together they are a hallway. You can pace it for years.

What actually stopped you

When the week dies, it is usually one of four: An excuse dressed as a reason A mistake you treated as a verdict A distraction you treated as work A lack of conviction — you did not believe the destination enough to spend the fifteen minutes Can’t. Won’t. Don’t. Can’t is skills and hours. Those can be built.

Won’t is a decision.

Don’t is the week with no Point B. Believe and achieve is not a poster. It is the

refusal to let can't / won't / don't pick the ceiling and the floor for you.

Fail on purpose

Failure is not the ceiling. It is not the floor. It is the work. You have to aim at misses. You have to collect them. A week with no failure is a week that stayed in the hallway. If the goal is small enough that you cannot fail it, it was not a Point B. It was a chore. Raise it until a miss is possible. Then take the step that might miss. Ship the ugly version. Ask the number that might get a no. Put fifteen minutes on the calendar for the thing that could embarrass you. Count the miss. That miss is data. It is not a verdict and it is not your name. Fear of failure keeps you under the ceiling. Fear of being a failure keeps you above the floor. Striving for failure — and actually getting some — is how you leave the hallway. You do not need to love the miss. You need the next one on the list.

Commitment

Resolve. This is sacrifice and failure. You already met the two fears. Fear of failure puts a ceiling on how high you will go. Fear of failing — of being a failure — puts a floor under how far you will drop. Both keep you in the hallway. Failure is not those fears. Failure is what you collect on purpose if the goal is large enough. That section still stands. Read it again if the chair got loud. Commitment is staying on the goal after you know what it will cost. Steadfast. Willing to work. Willing to give things up. Dedication. Resolve. Unstoppable is the word people want. The honest word is sacrifice. You leave the safe beach. The first raft sinks. You build another one. When the water hits a rock, determination cuts. Commitment is deciding the rock is not a reason to go back to shade.

What you have

Now — what do you actually have for the crossing? Time: sixteen waking hours, seven days.

Attention: less than that. Call it twelve if you are honest.

Skills. Assets. The ability to listen and to speak. Those hours already go somewhere. Sleep. Work. Social. Recreation. There is no spare pile labeled “goal” until you take it from one of those. If you work full time, part time, two jobs, or a job and school, you do not have the same open blocks as a person with a blank weekday. You still have the same twenty-four hours as anyone who has already done a goal like yours. You have some time. Fifteen minutes on a weekday. A

stretch on the weekend. Some amount. Do not trade sleep for time. Sleep is not optional. Seven to nine hours, every night. If your plan is to steal the goal out of those hours, stop. That is not commitment. That is a crash you scheduled.

How much you will give

No one cares how much time you “have.” No one cares how much you can squeeze. Holidays, obligations, the show, the game — those are not the measurement. The measurement is how much time you will commit to the goal. Write it. Weekdays:

Weekends:

Week total:

Month:

Year: Did you remember birthdays? Holidays? The annual trip? Over-commit and you will lie to the page. Under-commit and you are still on the beach. Be high. Be real. If something will pull you out and you already know it, subtract it now. How important is this to you?

How large is the goal? You do not go from CEO to a better CEO in an hour a day. You do not go from broke to a million in fifteen minutes a day. You do not write a book in one sitting. You do not eat an elephant off one plate. Anything you are willing to spend more time on than you are willing to commit to the goal is more important than the goal. That sentence is the whole lesson. The sacrifice is whatever loses to the highlight on the schedule. If nothing loses, you did not commit. You visited. The fears show up here. Sacrifice looks like failure to the people who liked the old version of you. Failure looks like sacrifice that did not pay last week. Stay anyway. That is resolve.

Work

Same page. Same goal. Do not start a second list. Fill in the time lines: weekday, weekend, week, month, year. Name one thing that will get less time so the goal can get more. That is the sacrifice. Write it. Name the failure you are willing to collect first — the ugly version, the no, the sunk raft. Write it under the goal. Make a basic 24-hour × 7-day grid, or print one. Highlight the blocks that belong to the goal. If a block is not highlighted and not sleep, it is competing. Treat it that way. You just told the calendar what it is allowed to protect.

Cycle 5

Shiny objects. Squirrels. A repeat is the same leak every week. A squirrel is new. It shows up mid-block and pretends it is the goal. Build a bin. Five lids: Computer — tabs, apps, a new file that is not the task. Physical — the thing on the desk that is not the work. People — the text, the drop-in, the “got a minute.” Things — stuff you want to buy, fix, or rearrange instead of crossing. Mind — the idea that arrives at minute twelve of the forty-five. When it shows up, it goes in the bin. It does not get the forty-five. Best version I have seen: a loud sticky that says Squirrel. Put it on the object. Put it on the monitor bezel. Rename the contact. When you look at it, or when they ping you, the brain gets the label before it gets the chase. The bin is not a trash can you never open. It is a later page. After the block. After the day. Most of it dies there. The one that is real becomes a task under the goal you already have — or it waits for the next Don’t Have and Want.

Work

Same page. Cycle # 5. Make the five headings. Computer. Physical. People. Things. Mind. For one day, every squirrel goes under a heading. Time if you have it. Label one object and one contact. Sticky or name. Squirrel. Do not start the squirrel during the forty-five. Week 6 is when you skip the block and call it a reason. Different animal.

Week 6

Cycle 6

The block dies two ways this week. A sentence you tell yourself. A room that makes the sentence easy. One cycle. Both. A distraction pulls you. It already has a bin. An obstacle is in the way. It gets a next action. An excuse is how you miss the task on purpose and keep your dignity. Do not blow off the task and call it a distraction. It is not. X calls. X pages. X minutes. You either did it or you did not. The power goes out. That is an obstacle. Find somewhere else. Then set up so the next outage does not end the block. Sit in the dark and wait, and that is an excuse. Reasons and rationality do not exist here. That reasonable sentence is an excuse wearing a tie. The fire test still works. If you would not stop running out of the burning building because of it, it is an excuse. The job is the task you wrote. The room is the other half of the same miss. Sleep is still not optional. A wrecked desk will wreck the forty-five anyway. The place is either helping or it is a squirrel with four walls. Sight — phone gone, tabs closed, squirrel sticky where your eyes land, pile off the desk. Sound — notifications off, door, headphones. A podcast in the forty-five is usually a leak. Feel — chair and temperature fixed once. Do not spend the block hunting a sweater. Smell — garbage, dishes, the candle you light to stall. Clear it. Then work. If the room pulls you off the task, the room is an obstacle. Stop, fix, or it keeps winning.

Work

Same page. Cycle # 6. Pull every line from the week that looks like a reason you missed the block. Mark: distraction, obstacle, or excuse. Distraction in the bin. Obstacle gets a next action. Excuse gets crossed out. You still owe the task. Sit where you actually do the forty-five. Write what you see, hear, feel, smell that is not the task. Pick one. Clean it, mute it, move it, or take it out. Rewrite today's work as a count. Run one 45/15 in that room. Mark whether the excuse or the room still stole the block. Week 7 is tools — laundry, dishes, coffee, commute, and the goal. Bare hands are a choice. Usually a bad one.

Week 7

Cycle 7

Tools. Leverage. Delegate. Automate. Be efficient. Week 6 cleaned the room so the forty-five could start. This week the room is a factory floor. How far do you walk from task to task. How far do your people walk. Put the tool on the path. Same rule on the disk: you should find anything that belongs to the work in one minute, file or drawer. That is efficiency. That is not wiping the desk. Bare hands are a choice. Usually a bad one. Tools. The instrument in your hand. Hammer. Template. Checklist. Software that writes the first draft so you are not a five-person content team. Sixty minutes to ten leaves fifty for the goal. Leverage. Same hands, more output. People will tell you the work is handmade, or that thinking cannot be touched by a machine, and they will use that as a reason to stay slow. A friend makes leather holsters. Eighteen-month waitlist. Very good at the work. For years the line was: automation cannot touch this. Handmade. Feel. Intuition. A 3D printer showed up anyway. Then six more machines. They run almost without stopping. The holsters are still made by hand. The craft did not die. Jigs, accessories, parts, the lines around the holster — those are machine. The product line got wider and taller. The waitlist changed shape. What left was the hours spent insisting a robot could not hold a jig. That is leverage. One setup that serves ten units. A printer next to the bench. AI on the post, the email, the first pass — not because the thinking vanished, because the stubborn hours did. “A machine can’t do what I do” is usually true about the last inch and a lie about the other eleven. Delegate. Math. Cost in any form for you to finish the task versus cost in any form for someone else to finish it. Hours that are cheaper than yours. Hands that are faster than yours. If they cost less, or they are more efficient, the task leaves your block. That is the whole rule. Pride is not a line item. Automate. People get loud about AI and machines because they are afraid. Afraid the job ends. The point of a life is that the current setting ends. You move up. Better work. Better life. Less time on the same motion. You do not sit in comfort hand-making footballs for forty years so you can retire and die of boredom. The fear is comfort in a costume. Put the repeating motion on a machine. Then go do the inch only you can do. Be efficient. Distance. Chair to printer. Click-path to the file. More than a minute to find the tool or the document, and the layout is stealing the forty-five. Move the tool. Name the file. Shorten the walk. You and anyone who works in the same room. Laundry. Dishes. Coffee. Commute. Knock off the useless pride. Outsource it. Automate it. That is not

beneath you. That is how the goal gets the forty-five.

Work

Same page. Cycle # 7. Write the parked repeats. Next to each: tool, leverage, delegate, automate, or already efficient. Then the next action. Under the one goal, mark this week's tasks the same way. Circle the ones you have been protecting with "handmade" or "a machine can't think." For one task, write your cost versus someone else's cost. If theirs is lower, or they are faster, it leaves your block. Time one hunt: tool or file. Over a minute, fix the path. Walk the room. Shorten the walk. One upgrade only. Then one 45/15. Write what the hour bought that it did not buy last week. Week 8 is getting your name off the job so the hour can go on something larger. SOP, train, inspect. The five words above are how. The last week is leaving.

Week 8

Cycle 8

Get yourself out of the job. Not so you can sit. So you can do the work that uses more of the brain. So output multiplies. So Self, Family, Friends, Faith, Career actually get hours. More time. More output. More of what you marked as valuable on Have / Want. That is the point of the eight weeks. That is time creation. This cycle is employment and company. The work that pays. The tasks that keep a role or a business alive. It is not Family night. Do not outsource the living parts of a life and call it a system. Exceptions that still count as tools: a tutor, a nanny, help with the work around family so you can be there. Not a substitute for being there. Week 7 put the five words in your hand: tools, leverage, delegate, automate, be efficient. This week those words take your name off the block. The job is not to be busy. The job is the goal, plus sustaining livelihood. If a work task still needs you after it has a tool, a person, and a written method, you built a shrine to being needed. That is comfort. Comfort stays in the building. Comfort never gets the next island. Comfort hand-makes the football for forty years and calls it a career. You cannot do higher-level work while you are still the person who answers every exception, runs every recurring chore inside the company, and is the only one who “knows how.” Bigger needs a hole in the calendar that used to have your name on it. That hole is the point. Fill it with G, or with the people you said you would not steal time from. Do not fill it with a squirrel. Do not fill it by doing the old job in secret. SOP. Write the steps. Ugly is fine. The next person should be able to do the task without texting you. If you cannot write it, you do not understand it yet, or it is not a task — it is a performance you are using to stay important. Train. Walk them through it. Watch them do it. Let them miss. That miss is the failure you were told to collect. Then they do it without you. Training that never ends is not training. It is you keeping the leash. Automate. The same motion every time should not wait for your mood. Recurring. Script. Machine. The fifty minutes a tool bought you last week belong here if a person should not be touching them at all. The fear that a machine takes the job is the fear of leaving the current setting. Leaving the current setting is the goal. Delegate. Math. Your cost versus theirs. Cheaper hours. Faster hands. Hand off the work and the decision next to the work. If every exception comes back to you, you delegated a chore and kept the job. Inspect. Sample the output. Do not sit in the forty-five and redo it. If the output is wrong, fix the SOP or the training. Do not steal the task back and call it standards. Stealing it back is how founders and

managers stay small. Be efficient. The walk and the click-path still count after you leave. If they cannot find the tool in a minute, you did not leave. You hid. Run this on the company repeats first — the report nobody reads, the inbox that is not the goal, the coffee, the process you invented when you were the only employee. Then run it on the goal's tasks that are not the last inch only you can do. That inch should shrink. That is how a role becomes a business. That is how a job stops being a cage. When the task no longer needs your name on the block, you did not get lazy. You created time. Same twenty-four hours. More brain on the goal. More output. More of the life you circled.

Work

Same page. Work tasks only. Cycle # 8. List the tasks that still have your name on them at work or in the company. Circle the ones that should not. Pick one. Write the SOP. Steps. Done looks like what. Mark the next move: tool, leverage, delegate, automate. Do that move this week. Write how you will inspect without taking the task back. Take that block off your 45/15. Put it on the one goal, or on Family time that is actually you. If nothing leaves your work page, you are still the bottleneck. The other island does not care that you were indispensable. It cares whether you got in.

You are creating time

You are in a burning building on an island. The room still has a chair. The beach still has shade. Across the water you can see the other shore. The week is familiar. Familiar is comfort. Comfort stays. Ninety-nine percent stay. They are comfortable. They are afraid. Ceiling. Floor. Sharks. A story instead of a swim. Comfort is first. Survival is second. Waiting for the government, God, family, or the lottery is neither. That is sitting in the smoke and calling it a plan. That is why you can see Point B and still not get in the water. If you already have the vision — five priorities, a company that notices when the calendar lies — the executive move is short. Write the five. Delete what is not the five. Fifteen-minute blocks, fourteen days out. Two weeks to see that time and priorities were never friends. Most people do not have that vision yet. That is why this book went longer, and why it costs hundreds of times less than an hour of the training it came from. Week 0: Point B. Have and Want. The pile. Week 1: ink. Week 2: one rabbit. Goal. Milestones. Tasks. Week 3: Focus. Forty-five and fifteen. Week 4: the wall. Repeats. Week 5: failure you collect. Hours you will give up. Squirrels in a bin. Week 6: the excuse and the room. Week 7: tools, leverage, delegate, automate, efficient. Pride off the dishes. Week 8: your name off the job. Higher-level work. More brain. More output. More Self, Family, Friends, Faith, Career. More of what you circled. Eight weeks if you do the weeks. A typical week. Not vacation. Not the Monday you performed for the log. Do that and, on average, you are looking at about seventy-five percent more time than when you started — time that used to be Other, excuses, and repeats. For a lot of people the clock does not change and the output does. Same twenty-four. Magnitudes more of Don't Have and Want. More of the life that is not a chair. You did not invent a twenty-fifth hour. You stopped paying the ones you had to comfort. You can have anything you want. You cannot have everything you want. You can stay on this island and keep the view. Or you can leave the building and swim. You are creating time. The water does not care that you were busy. It cares whether you got in.